HEXLEY CHEMICALS

Statement Guide: Access

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1. What this guide covers

This guide covers access: getting to the work position and working there - scaffolds, mobile elevating work platforms, ladders, fixed platforms and rope access, the working height, edge protection and harnesses, the barriers below the work, the wind, and the depth of a dig with its support. It appears in method statements and task risk assessments, most of all for work at height and excavation.

The guide is used by the Permit Coordinator or Area Authority who opens a review - the reviewer in this guide - and by the Area Authority who decides it. Whether a requirement is met is a separate question, settled by the request and its permit type's own standard. This guide is about what the documents show: the tools flag only a gas reading that differs from the request's, as the Permit Rules set out, and every other check here is the reviewer's own.

2. How it shows up in a statement

A sentence of this kind usually says one of these:

- the access method and the working height in metres
- a scaffold inspected and tagged before use
- edge protection, or harnesses clipped to an anchor
- the area below the work barriered, or barriers around a dig
- the wind at the work position in metres per second, and the depth of a dig with its support

3. What the reviewer checks

These are the checks the reviewer makes, in this order:

1 Find the request's access answers, and for a dig its depth and its support.

2 Read each sentence of this kind for the access, the height, the protection and the barriers.

3 Compare a stated working height, wind or depth with the request's.

4 Note a sentence saying a scaffold is not inspected or the sides of a dig are not supported.

5 Check the barriers keep people out from below the work, or back from the edge.

4. Requirements it bears on

Access bears on the fall protection, scaffold inspection, barriers and wind speed requirements of the work at height standard, and on the trench support and barriers requirements of the excavation standard.

5. When the statement and the request disagree

When a statement describes another access method, height, wind or depth than the request, the reviewer notes it for the Area Authority and keeps the request's answers, which still decide the requirements.

6. What to ask the requester for

Ask the performing authority for the access method and the working height, the scaffold tag where a scaffold is used, the fall protection and the barriers, the wind at the work position outdoors, and for a dig its depth and its support.

7. Telling it apart

What gets a person to the work and keeps them from falling is access, a harness clipped to an anchor included; what the work party wears to protect themselves at the work is personal protective equipment, which the Personal Protective Equipment guide covers. "Everyone at height wears a harness clipped on" is access; "hard hats and safety boots are worn" is personal protective equipment.